

ROXANA GONZALEZ

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Citizenship: United States

EDUCATION

Expected Dec. 2026	Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina
May 2022	B.A. in Economics, University of Tennessee (<i>Cum Laude</i>)

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Urban Economics, Public Economics, Large Language Models

RESEARCH PAPERS

“Opportunity Zones & Housing Supply”
Sole-Authored
Under Review, Journal of Urban Economics

“What Can LLMs Tell Us About the ETI?”
with Jason DeBacker and Max Ghenis

“Opportunity for Affordability: Tax Incentives and Rental Housing Markets”
Sole-Authored
Recipient of the Best Third-Year Paper Award

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Effectiveness of Local Flavored E-Cigarette Bans”
with Kara Jones and Danna Thomas

HONORS, GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2026	SPARC Graduate Research Grant (\$5,000), University of South Carolina Office of Research
2026	Graduate School Travel Grant (\$800), University of South Carolina Graduate School
2025	Melayne Morgan McInnes Memorial Award for Best Third-Year Paper (\$1,000), University of South Carolina Moore School of Business
2022	Summer Program Scholar, American Economic Association (AEA)
2018–2022	Pledge Scholar, University of Tennessee

PRESENTATIONS

2026	American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference; American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) International Conference (<i>Accepted</i>)
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2025	Southern Economics Association (SEA) Annual Conference; American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference
2024	Association for Public Policy and Management (APPAM) Annual Conference; American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference

TEACHING POSITIONS

Department of Economics, University of South Carolina Moore School of Business

Instructor of Record

Spring 2026 Introduction to Economics

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026 Professor Lois Miller

Spring 2025 Professor Sang Min Lee

Spring–Fall 2024 Professor Danna Thomas

Fall 2023 Professor Tamara Sheldon

RESEARCH POSTIONS

2025–2026	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Summer 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
Spring 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
2024	Research Assistant to Professor Danna Thomas, University of South Carolina
Fall 2023	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
2022–2023	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Spring 2022	Research Assistant to Professor Kin Blackburn, University of South Carolina
2021–2022	Research Assistant to Professor Maria Padilla-Romo, University of Tennessee

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Aug. 2025–present	Workforce Data Scientist (part-time), South Carolina Department of Employment and Workforce
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PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026	Job Market Boot Camp, American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference
2025	Summer School in Urban Economics, Urban Economics Association, Tufts University
2024	Applied Data Analytics Training, Coleridge Initiative (confidential micro-data, record linkage, and machine learning)
2022	Summer Training Program, American Economic Association (AEA)

SKILLS

Statistical Software / Programming: Python, SQL, Stata, R

Quantitative Methods: Causal inference, regression, predictive modeling, machine learning

Data Skills: Collection, cleaning, validation, documentation, and dissemination of large datasets

Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

Service: First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

SERVICE

First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

REFERENCES

Dr. Jason DeBacker

Associate Professor of Economics

University of South Carolina

jason.debacker@moore.sc.edu

(770) 289-0340

Relationship: Graduate Research Advisor

Dr. Danna Thomas

Assistant Professor of Economics

University of South Carolina

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(256) 452-7415

Relationship: Faculty Mentor